Esylen saw Sivarasan again the next day when he was sitting on the steps. Mustering up the courage, as such an opportunity she realized may never come again, she asked if he was employed somewhere nearby. The fugitive reportedly said no, and that he was trying to land a job in Dubai. At that time, Esylen noticed he had two eyes. One looked artificial. It was at that moment that she thought of going to the CBI office and telling them everything. But nobody in her family agreed because it was not safe.[10]



Anirudhya stepped into the hideout after the raiding team had left. In the living room, where the assassination was planned, photographs of Rajiv Gandhi, Jayalalithaa and M.G. Ramachandran, the founder of the AIADMK, still adorned the walls.

He rushed back to his hotel to call the Delhi office. A message from Harpal was left below the hotel-room door. It said, ‘Hey, got your last filing. Thanks. Bobb was asking for info on Shubha, the other human bomb. Asap.’ True, anyone had hardly written about her. The limelight had been stolen first by Dhanu and then by ‘One-Eyed Jack’.

Shubha was no less important a target in the manhunt—she was proving to be just as elusive as Sivarasan. Verma, from the confession of Murugan, felt the two were not together. No one in their custody could give them any information on Shubha’s whereabouts. Murugan claimed that even if Shubha was caught, chances of getting anything from her were remote. Being a member of the LTTE’s suicide squad, she always carried a cyanide pill as a pendant around her neck. Murugan said they took pride in biting the cyanide capsule. It was his misfortune that he could not.

While the investigators were getting closer to catching Sivarasan and gang, the courtroom battle was intensifying. IO Ragothaman spent more time in court, responding to petitions filed by Peraribalan, who designed the bomb, and Padma, Nalini’s mother, who claimed to have no knowledge of any assassination plot. They were asking for access to legal assistance, citing it was their constitutional right. Their petitions were prepared by